15 SCRIPTS FOR THE 5 MOMENTS INSIDE YOUR MEETINGS

Stop Losing The Room

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1 The kickoff

“You open the weekly team meeting.”

Low: “Thanks for joining, everyone. Let us just dive in, I guess.”

Average: “Today we are going over the launch checklist and the open bugs.”

> THE HIGH LINE
>
> **“We leave this room with a launch date picked. 20 minutes on the checklist, then we choose the date before 10:30.”**

A meeting with no stated outcome drifts to whoever talks longest. Name what the room leaves with, give the work a block of time, and put a clock on the decision. Say it in the first 30 seconds.

2 The decision ask

“20 minutes in. Plenty of talk, no decision yet.”

Low: “Let us keep going and see where we land by the end.”

Average: “Can we try to make a decision on this one today?”

> THE HIGH LINE
>
> **“Two options are on the table. Option B costs 2 weeks and closes 40 open tickets. I recommend B. Let us call it now.”**

Talk expands until someone frames the choice. Name the options, price the one you recommend, and ask for the call out loud. Then stop talking and let the room answer.

3 The derail

“A senior leader pulls the meeting onto a side topic.”

Low: “Sure, we can talk about that too. It is all related anyway.”

Average: “Good topic. Maybe we can park that one for later?”

> THE HIGH LINE
>
> **“That one deserves its own room. I will book 30 minutes on Thursday. Back to the launch date: we still owe a call.”**

Senior people derail meetings because nobody protects the agenda out loud. Give the side topic a real slot on a real day, then return to the decision in the same breath. You sound helpful and firm at once.

4 The disagreement

“The room is about to approve a plan you think is wrong.”

Low: “I guess that could work.”

Average: “I am not fully sure, but let us go with it for now.”

> THE HIGH LINE
>
> **“I disagree, and here is the number behind it: the last launch like this dropped activation about 8 points. Test it on 10% first.”**

Folding in the room and venting after it changes nothing, and people remember it. Bring one number from a past launch and one smaller test the room can run. Now the room is arguing about data, not about you.

5 The close

“Two minutes left. Nothing has an owner or a date yet.”

Low: “Okay, thanks everyone. We will sort it out in the chat.”

Average: “Let us sync again next week and check the open items.”

> THE HIGH LINE
>
> **“Before we drop: Priya owns the checklist by Wednesday. I send the date email today. We meet Friday only if the review slips.”**

If nobody says who owns the work, it sits in the chat until someone asks about it next week. Say the names and the dates out loud before people stand up, so everyone leaves knowing their job. The chat recap is the backup.

Practice on this one

Your next team meeting is already on the calendar. Rehearse the kickoff line once before it: the outcome, the time block, the decision clock. 20 seconds out loud. Then open the meeting with it.

Score your last meeting

- ☐ Did I say what the room leaves with, inside the first minute?
- ☐ Did I name the options before I asked for a decision?
- ☐ Did I give every side topic a day instead of my agenda?
- ☐ Did I bring a number when I disagreed?
- ☐ Did I protect the decision time from the discussion time?
- ☐ Did I say the owners and the dates out loud before the close?

Four or more checked: you are running the room at the high level. Under four: pick the weakest moment and run its script in your next meeting.